

File Endpoint

Link: <https://docs.mulesoft.com/file-connector/latest/file-studio-configuration>

Link: <https://mulesy.com/category/3-mulesoft-working-samples/connectors/file/>

File Endpoint, typically represented by the "<file:listener>" component, is used to handle files and file system operations. It can be configured to act as an inbound endpoint (triggering a flow when a new file is added or modified in a directory) or as an outbound endpoint (writing files to the file system)

Inbound Endpoint (Message Source):

Function:

The "<file:listener>" component polls a directory and triggers a new message when a new file is created or updated within that directory.

Configuration:

You need to specify the directory to listen to and the file matching criteria (e.g., file type, name, etc.).

Example:

When a new file is placed in a specified directory, the Mule flow will be triggered, and the file's content will be available as the message payload.

Outbound Endpoint (Message Processor):

Function: You can use the File Connector to write files to the file system within a Mule flow.

Configuration: Configure the File Connector with the desired directory and file name.

Example: A flow could read data from a database, transform it, and then write it to a file in a specified directory.

Key Features and Considerations:

File Matching:

The "<file:listener>" component supports file matching criteria, allowing you to only trigger flows for specific files that meet certain conditions.

Watermark:

Mule 4 automatically supports watermarks, allowing you to optionally filter by file creation or modification timestamps.

Error Handling:

In Mule 4, errors during a file operation (e.g., deletion or move) prevent the operation from occurring, regardless of whether there's a transaction.

Streaming:

For large files, consider using the "No repeatable iterable" option for the Streaming strategy when using the "List" operation to avoid potential OutOfMemoryError issues.

Error Handling with Transactions:

If an error occurs during a file operation within a transaction, the operation is rolled back, and the file is not deleted or moved.